



YOUTH AND WOMEN EMANCIPATION (Yawe)

REACTS-IN PROJECT ANNUAL REPORT 2025



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Acknowledgement

I would like to express my heartfelt gratitude to Almighty God for His protection and blessings throughout the implementation of the 2025 project activities. I extend my sincere thanks to the REACTS-IN Project team from WVT for their cooperation and support.

I also appreciate the dedication and commitment of the YAWE team under the REACTS-IN Project toward the project's success. A special thanks goes to Mr. Sebastian Manoni, the Project Accountant from YAWE, for his invaluable contributions in managing logistics and actively participating in the project.

Lastly, I would like to recognize Mr. Vicent Laurent, the Project Coordinator, for his outstanding coordination and meticulous planning of the project activities.

Acronyms and Abbreviations

BCC – Behaviour Change Communication

CHWs – Community Health Workers

GBV – Gender based violence

GBV – Gender Based Violence

Program H – Gender equality activity for Adolescent girls

Program M – Gender equality activities for Adolescent girls

RCH – Reproductive and Child Health

REACTS-IN – Realizing Gender Equality, Attitudinal Change and Transformative Systems in Nutrition

SRHR – Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights

VAC – Violence against Children

WASH – Water sanitation and Hygiene

WVT – World Vision Tanzania

YAWE – Youth and Women Emancipation

Executive Summary

In 2024, the Youth and Women Emancipation (Yawe) successfully implemented key components of the REACTS-IN Project, a seven-year initiative funded by Global Affairs Canada and coordinated by World Vision Tanzania (WVT). The project aims to strengthen nutrition and health systems with a focus on gender equality, sexual and reproductive health, and nutrition outcomes for women, adolescent girls, and children under five in Maswa and Meatu District Councils of the Simiyu Region.

During the reporting period, Yawe focused on enhancing family planning services, promoting sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), and preventing gender-based violence (GBV) through school- and community-based interventions. A total of 14,864 clients accessed family planning services, of whom 82 per cent were women and 18 percent were men, reflecting strong awareness and uptake of reproductive health services. Additionally, 113 health facility workers (58 men and 55 women) were trained in community-based distribution of contraceptives, infection prevention, and client-centred counselling.

Yawe also conducted monthly family planning promotion events across 57 wards and 94 villages, reaching 6,205 community members through sports, art, and dialogue-based activities that promoted male participation and shared responsibility in family planning. Furthermore, 3,500 adolescent-friendly behaviour change communication (BCC) materials on contraceptives were produced and distributed in schools, youth clubs, and other gathering points such as hairdressing salons. Through the district-level school sports competition known as the “Zero GBV Award,” Yawe reached 20,574 adolescents, comprising 11,885 girls and 8,689 boys, with SRHR and GBV prevention education.

The project’s implementation generated several key lessons. Flexibility and adaptive management were crucial in maintaining progress despite delays in fund disbursement. Early engagement of teachers, community health workers, and local leaders enhanced participation, cooperation, and sustainability. Increased male participation in family planning activities demonstrated that inclusive strategies can effectively challenge gender norms. Regular training and support for health workers strengthened their technical capacity and service delivery quality.

Despite these successes, the project experienced challenges related to delayed funding, which affected the timely execution of planned activities. To address this, timely disbursement of funds is recommended to ensure smooth implementation. Additionally, the report recommends scaling up dialogue-based and sports-driven approaches for SRHR and GBV education, continuing to engage men and boys in reproductive health advocacy, and strengthening school-based SRHR education through teacher involvement.

Background

REACTS-IN project is a seven-year partnership project that seeks to support the strengthening of nutrition and health systems with a focus on the gender dimensions of malnutrition and contributes to achieving the World Health Assembly's global nutrition targets. The program is implemented using multi-sectoral, evidence-based approaches that address the key determinants of nutrition, gender inequalities and sexual reproductive health to improve the health and nutrition of women, adolescent girls and children under five in Tanzania, specifically in Meatu and Maswa district councils of Simiyu region with funding from Global Affairs Canada.

In Tanzania, the REACTS-IN project is implemented in two districts of Maswa and Meatu in Simiyu Region and seeks to achieve three objectives;

- Ensure women and adolescent girls have equitable access to nutrition, health, WASH (Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene) and SRHR practices.
- Enhance the availability and quality of gender-equitable and responsive nutrition, health and SRH services.
- Strengthen the effectiveness of local stakeholders in realizing the nutrition and SRH rights of women and girls.

Outputs and Activities implemented by YAWE in 2025

In the year 2025, YAWE has implemented the following outputs and their activities:

Output III3: Technical Support, including on-the-job coaching facilitated to district medical team on community-based family planning strategies to increase demand and utilization of family planning/contraceptives (FP&C)

Activity: I Conduct Quarterly monitoring of CHWs on the implementation of Community-based distribution of family planning methods

Under this activity, YAWE conducted a monitoring visit to CHWs and recorded 14,864 (12,217F & 94M) men and women using contraceptives.

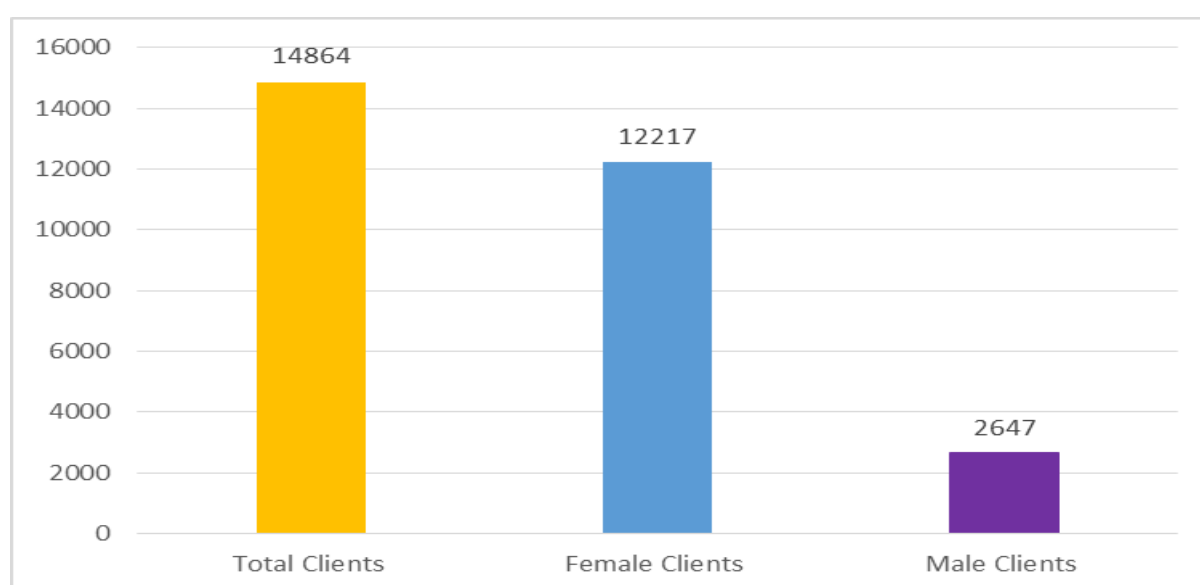


Figure 1: Shows number of clients received contraceptives services and health facilities visited from January – March 2025

As illustrated in Figure 1 above, a total of **14,864 clients** from both **Maswa and Meatu Districts** accessed family planning services between **October 2024 and September 2025**. Of these, **12,217 were female** (accounting for approximately 82.19 %) and **2,647 were male** (representing 17.81%). This data reflects a strong uptake of family planning services among women, which is consistent with national trends showing higher participation of women in reproductive health initiatives compared to men.

During the same period, a total of **68 health facilities** were visited as part of routine monitoring activities. These visits aimed to assess service delivery quality, ensure availability of contraceptive commodities, and strengthen the capacity of health providers to deliver client-centred family planning counseling.

The findings highlight progress in expanding access to reproductive health services while also indicating a continuing need to enhance **male involvement** in family planning education and outreach efforts.

Activity 2. Facilitate training to health facility workers on the implementation of community-based distribution of family planning Methods

Under this activity, YAWE organized and trained health facility workers from Maswa and Meatu



Figure 2: Shows the number of trained health facility workers from Maswa and Meatu.

As illustrated in the figure above, a total of 113 health facility workers participated in a five-day intensive training focused on enhancing the quality of Family Planning (FP) and Reproductive and Child Health (RCH) services. The training equipped participants with practical knowledge and skills in managing RCH clinics to ensure effective delivery of FP and related services.

Key areas covered included adherence to infection prevention protocols during FP service provision, client education to promote the uptake of FP methods, and counselling for informed choice. Participants were also trained to screen clients for appropriate FP methods and other RCH services, provide clients with methods of their choice, manage contraceptive-related complications, and accurately document and utilize FP client data for improved service delivery and decision-making. The training was aimed at imparting knowledge and skills to service providers to enable them to provide quality FP services at their respective facilities, as well as to manage clients presenting with side effects or complications related to method use.

The training cohort comprised 58 males and 55 females from 71 health facilities, reflecting a diverse group of participants committed to improving the quality and accessibility of reproductive health services. The sessions aimed to enhance participants' technical skills, strengthen their capacity to deliver client-centred family planning services, and promote adherence to infection prevention standards within health facilities.

Activity 3: Organize conduct monthly family planning promotion day including sports and art art-based activities (eg dramas, songs, soccer and other games)

Under this activity, YAWE conducted monthly family planning promotion day events in 57 wards, 94 villages, the table below indicates the number of beneficiaries reached during the events.

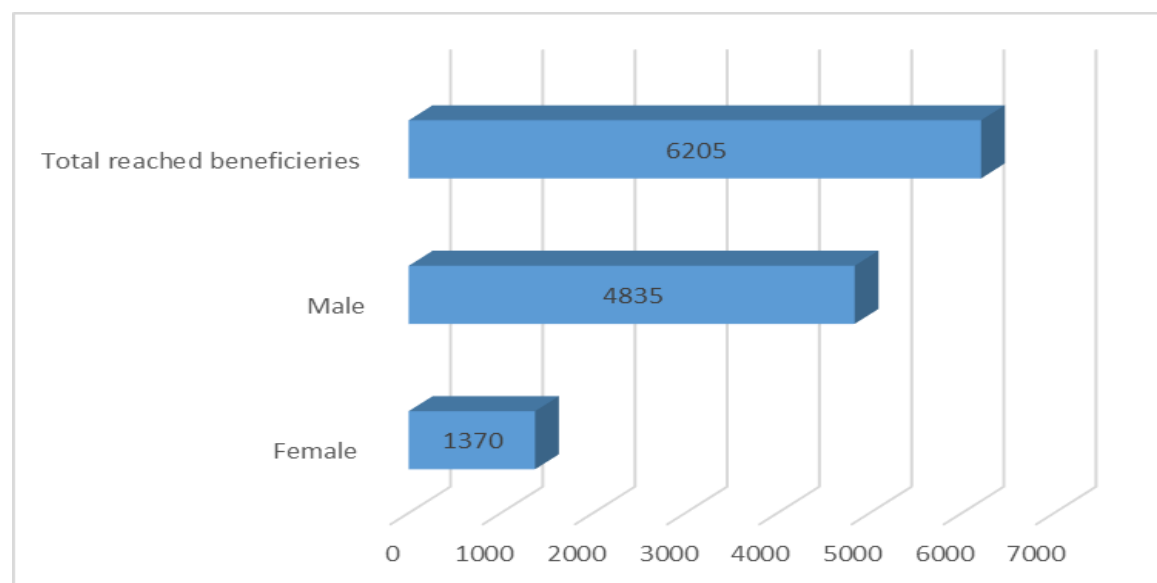


Figure 3: Shows the total number of beneficiaries reached during family planning promotion days

As illustrated in Figure 3, a total of 6,205 community members were reached through family planning awareness and sensitisation activities conducted via sports events. Among them, 4,835 were males (approximately 78%) and 1,370 were females (about 22%).

This data demonstrates a significant increase in male participation, indicating growing interest and engagement of men in family planning and reproductive health discussions. Such progress is essential in promoting shared decision-making between partners and addressing gender-related barriers that have historically limited women's access to family planning services.

Furthermore, the findings highlight the effectiveness of the community outreach strategies employed, particularly the integration of family planning messages into sports events, community dialogues, and public gatherings in engaging men and fostering wider community participation.

Maintaining and scaling up these inclusive and participatory approaches will be crucial in further enhancing awareness, acceptance, and utilization of family planning services among both men and women, thereby contributing to improved reproductive health outcomes in the targeted districts.

Activity 3: Develop adolescent friendly comprehensive BCC materials on contraceptives to be used in school and outside school clubs and key establishment where adolescents gather (e.g. hairdressers)

Yawe produced 3,500 adolescent-friendly comprehensive BCC materials on contraceptives to be used in school and outside school clubs and key establishments where adolescents gather (e.g., hairdressers).

Activity 4: Facilitate district-level annual schools' sports competition to promote SRHR and prevent GBV. “(Annual Zero GBV Award)”

Under this activity, Yawe organized and facilitated district-level annual schools' sport competition to promote SRHR and prevent GBV in 86 schools in both Maswa and Meatu, as the table below indicates:

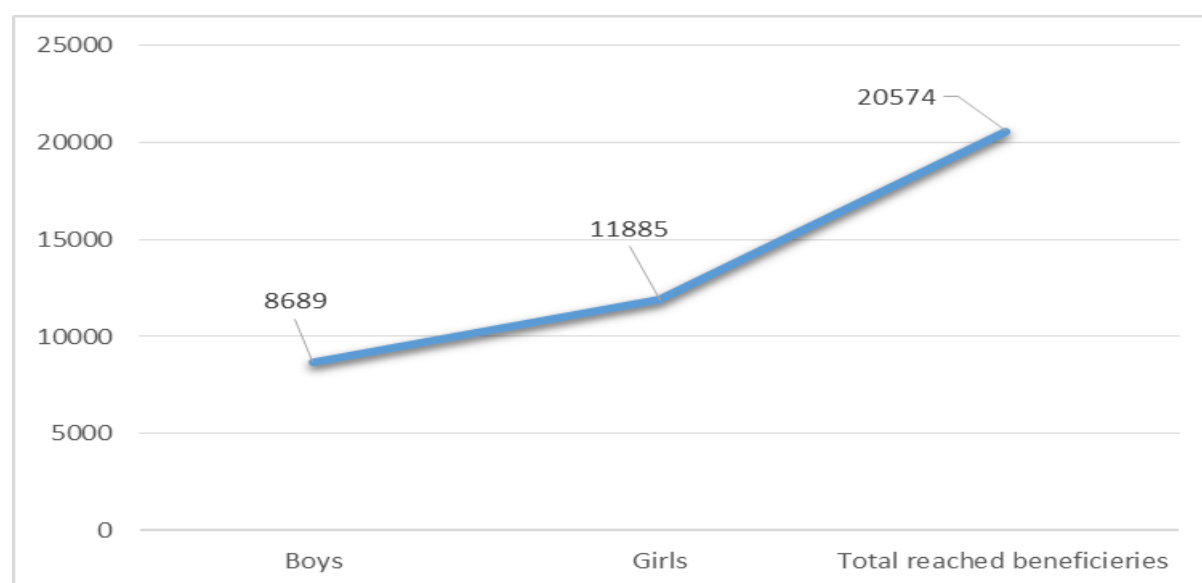


Figure 4: Shows the number of adolescents reached with SRHR and Anti GBV education during the annual sports competition.

As illustrated in the table above, during the annual school sports competitions, Yawe successfully reached a total of 20,574 adolescents with Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) and Anti-Gender-Based Violence (Anti-GBV) education. Among them, 11,885 were girls and 8,689 were boys, representing participants from all 86 schools under the M&H program.

While sports and other art-based activities were among the proposed approaches, Yawe strategically prioritized school dialogues due to their time efficiency and the late disbursement of quarterly funds, which limited the full implementation of some sports-related activities. Despite these constraints, the dialogues proved to be highly effective in facilitating meaningful engagement and interactive learning among adolescents.

This achievement underscores the effectiveness of combining dialogue-based learning with sports-driven engagement as complementary approaches for reaching young people with SRHR and Anti-GBV information. The high participation rates, especially among girls, reflect

growing awareness and willingness to engage in conversations around reproductive health, rights, and gender equality.

Overall, these interventions have significantly contributed to improving adolescents' knowledge, attitudes, and confidence to make informed health decisions and to take a stand against gender-based violence within their schools and communities.

Lesson learnt

- The ability to remain flexible and adjust implementation timelines and strategies based on real-time feedback from the field and stakeholders proved critical for successful activity execution. Adaptive management ensured continuity and effectiveness despite delays in fund disbursement.
- Early and continuous engagement of key stakeholders, especially teachers, community health workers, and local leaders, significantly improved participation, cooperation, and sustainability of project interventions. Schools served as strategic entry points for reaching adolescents with SRHR and GBV information.
- Increased participation of men in family planning awareness activities demonstrated that inclusive strategies can successfully challenge gender stereotypes and promote shared responsibility in reproductive health decision-making
- Regular training and on-the-job support for health facility workers enhanced their technical skills, confidence, and ability to provide quality family planning and reproductive health services, including effective data documentation and client management.
- Delays in fund disbursement affected the timely execution of planned activities. Early financial planning and timely release of funds are crucial to avoid compressed timelines and ensure comprehensive activity implementation.

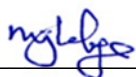
Recommendation

- To avoid disruptions in project implementation, funds should be disbursed promptly, particularly during quarter transitions, to allow adequate planning, preparation, and execution of scheduled activities
- Building on their proven effectiveness, both dialogue-based learning and sports-related activities should be scaled up as complementary platforms for reaching youth with SRHR and anti-GBV education.
- Continue to design and implement targeted initiatives that actively engage men and boys in family planning, GBV prevention, and gender equality advocacy to sustain the gains observed.
- Schools should remain key partners in adolescent-focused programs, with teachers empowered through continued training and involvement to deliver SRHR and GBV education effectively.

Challenges

Delays in funding disbursement for planned or upcoming activities have sometimes caused interruptions in the project timeline, leading to rushed work and increased pressure on the team.

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Appendix



